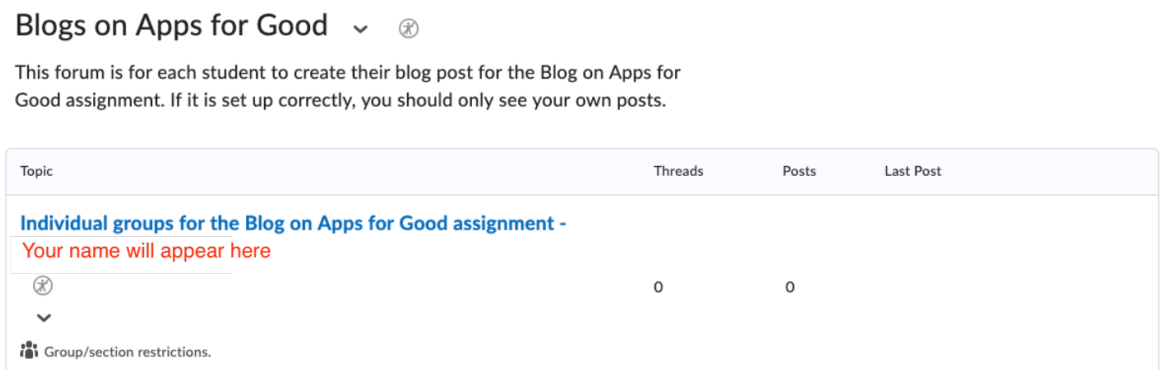
DHUM101: Blog-style reports on an app for good (10 marks)

Due date and time: 5pm, Friday 9 October. **Word Count**: 500 (guideline only)

For this assignment you are asked to install, use and evaluate an app that has been designed to achieve some social or environmental benefit. Your evaluation should be a sequence of posts in the style of a blog or journal that would be useful for someone to learn about the app and to determine whether they would like to use it. *You should use your own words, not repeat a marketing pitch from the app creators or someone else's review.*

In Aoroa, we have set up a private discussion forum for each student. Only you and the teaching staff will see your posts. You can access this by selecting "Matapaki | Discussions" from the Activities tab. The forum should be at the bottom of the page and look like this:



If you click on the blue text "Individual groups …", you will reach a page where you can start a new discussion thread for your posts.

Your tasks

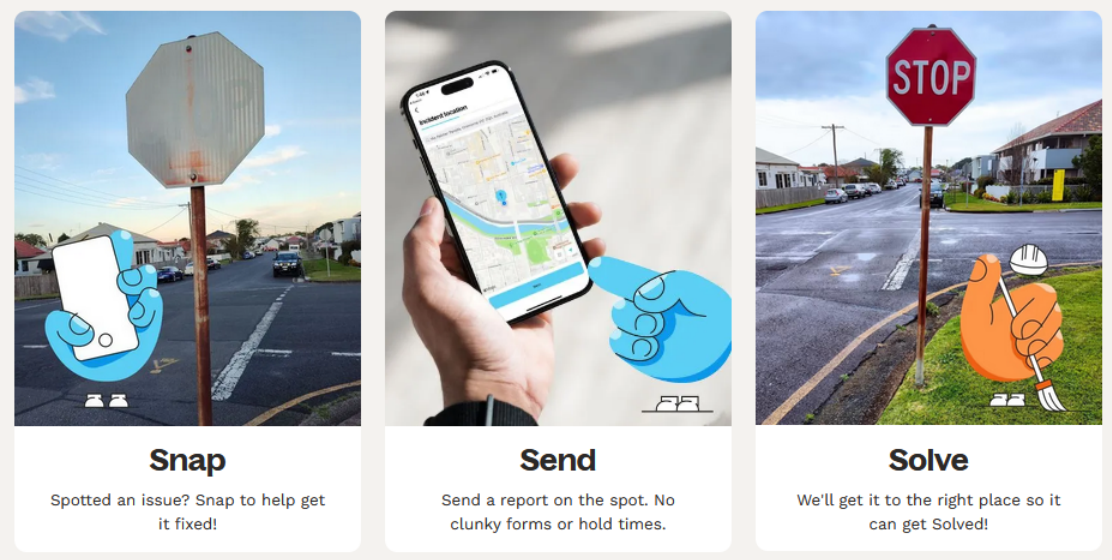
1. Choose an app from the list below, install it, check that it works on your device, and that the app is actually useful in Dunedin (that is particularly important for the two food rescue apps: they both list Dunedin cafes and restaurants, but it is not clear whether there are many opportunities for food rescue in Dunedin). There are no marks for reporting that an app didn't run at all or it was not usable in Dunedin. In those cases, try another app. Feel free to let us know if any of the apps in the list do not seem usable so we can warn other students.
2. Use the app for its intended purpose at least *three* times on different days. Try to test as many features of the app as you reasonably can (and mention any that you did not try). Create a blog or journal style post reporting on *each* use of the app. Your post should include:
    a. screenshots that illustrate its use,
    b. your impression of the app and how successfully it achieved its intended purpose when you used it.

3. Finally, post a reflection summarising your overall evaluation, including answers to the following questions.
    a. Does the app really contribute to “good” in some way? If so, what is that good? If you don’t think it contributes to some good, explain why not.
    b. Explain any features the app has to encourage you to keep contributing to good.
    c. Comment on any features of the app that would enhance the experience of frequent users, but which you did not need to use.
    d. Will you continue to use the app, and why or why not? If you wouldn’t, could you see yourself using it under different circumstances (e.g. if you were less busy, had more money or were older).

Apps to choose from

Help improve your community

Snap Send Solve
"The app helping keep shared spaces safe, clean and great to be in"
https://www.snapsendsolve.com. iOS and Android



DCC Kerbside Collection App
https://www.dunedin.govt.nz/services/rubbish-and-recycling/recycling-and-rubbish-collection#component_1028306. iOS and Android.
You should try all the features mentioned below, which are accessible from the Home tab.
“Dunedin City Council kerbside recycling days and rubbish and recycling directory. A handy app which helps you find what your collection day is and which fortnightly recycling collection is due. The app can send you a weekly notification reminding you to put out your rubbish and the right recycling bin 7pm the night prior.
The app also has a useful rubbish and recycling directory with information on other items that can be recycled and tips on reuse and reduction of waste going to landfill....”

Food Rescue

Get discounts on food that will otherwise go to waste. Both apps below list Dunedin businesses.

Foodprint
https://foodprint.app/. iOS and Android

Too Good To Go
https://www.toogoodtogo.com/en-nz. iOS and Android

Water bottle refill locations

RefillNZ
https://refillnz.org.nz/where-to-refill/ (use the app, not the web-based search form).
iOS and Android

Climate action

Earth Hero
"Earth Hero provides scientifically grounded tools and ideas to empower all who want to reduce emissions, improve lives, and care for our shared planet.
Track Your Progress. Achieve Climate Actions. Join a Community."
https://www.earthhero.org/. iOS and Android

More sustainable web search

Fund tree planting and plastic removal from the ocean as you search the web.

Ecosia browser
"We use all our profits for climate action, with the majority going into tree-planting projects around the world."
Ecosia browser: https://www.ecosia.org/browser. iOS and Android

OceanHero browser
"Revenue from users clicking on ads pays for the collection of ocean-bound plastic. On average every 5 searches in OceanHero helps recover one plastic bottle"
https://oceanhero.today/. Android (the iOS link on the web site does not seem to work)

Wave browser
Similar to OceanHero.
https://wavebrowser.co/. iOS and Android

Investment

Mindful Money (a web site, not an app, but that's OK)
https://mindfulmoney.nz/

- A Fund Checker that shows you what's in your KiwiSaver or investment fund.
- An independent comparison of your options for investing, using [their] high ethical standards and credible verification.
- A Fund Finder that enables you to choose KiwiSaver or retail investment funds that match your values.
- Educational news, blogs and guides, research and seminars on investing for good.